

Absolutely — **define** is a strong Tier 1 polysemy/family target because your passage uses it here:

> “...strangers on the internet do not know me well enough to **define** me.”

Here **define** does **not** mean “give a dictionary definition”. It means **to determine, describe, or limit what kind of person someone is**. The writer is saying that strangers’ comments should not decide their identity or worth.

Word family: **define / definition / defined / definite / definitive**

Base verb: define

Noun: definition

Participle/adjective: defined

Related adjectives: definite, definitive

Meaning in your passage: **define = determine what someone is / shape their identity — 界定 ; 定義 ; 決定某人是怎樣的人**

Your sentence:

> “strangers on the internet do not know me well enough to **define** me.”

Here **define** means:

> **to determine or describe the essential character, identity, or worth of a person.**

繁體中文 :

替一個人下定論、界定其本質或決定「這個人是怎樣的人」

Natural translation:

> “strangers on the internet do not know me well enough to define me”

「網上的陌生人根本不夠了解我，不能因此就**界定我是怎樣的人 / 替我下定論**。」

So here:

> **define = 決定 / 界定一個人的身份、特質或價值**

1. **define = explain the exact meaning of a word/concept — 定義 ; 解釋確切意思**

The core dictionary/academic meaning.

Practice 1

> “Can you **define** the word ‘viral’?”

「你可以**定義 / 解釋** ‘viral’ 這個字嗎？」

Practice 2

> “The textbook defines success as achieving a desired result.”

「教科書把 success **定義為**達到預期結果。」

define = 清楚說明某個字、概念或術語的確切意思

2. **define A as B** = 把 A 定義為 B

A major grammar pattern.

Practice 3

> “The law **defines** a minor **as** a person under a certain age.”

「法律把未成年人**定義為**未達某個年齡的人。」

Practice 4

> “Some people define success as wealth.”

「有些人把成功**定義為**財富。」

define A as B = 明確說明 A 所指的是 B

3. **define** = describe the essential character of something — 界定；說明本質

A broader conceptual sense.

Practice 5

> “Its warmth and quality **define** the bakery.”

「溫暖感和品質**塑造 / 界定了**這間麵包店的特色。」

Practice 6

> “Trust defines their relationship.”

「信任是**界定 / 塑造**他們關係的核心特質。」

****define = 顯示某人 / 某物最具代表性的核心特徵****

This is close to your source sense.

4. ****define = determine someone's identity/value — 界定某人；替某人下定論****

This is your exact passage sense.

Practice 7 — Original

> “Strangers online do not know me well enough to ****define**** me.”

「網上的陌生人不夠了解我，不能****替我下定論 / 界定我是怎樣的人****。」

Practice 8

> “One mistake does not define you.”

「一次犯錯並不能****決定你是一個怎樣的人****。」

****define — person = 把某個特點、事件或評價當成決定一個人身份 / 價值的標準****

Very common in motivational and reflective writing.

5. ****define = establish the limits/boundaries of something — 界定範圍；劃定****

A major formal sense.

Practice 9

> “We need to ****define**** the scope of the project.”

「我們需要****界定****這個項目的範圍。」

Practice 10

> “The agreement clearly defines each side’s responsibilities.”

「協議清楚**界定**雙方的責任。」

****define = 明確訂出某事物的範圍、界線、責任或限制****

Common with:

- * scope
- * role
- * responsibility
- * boundary
- * authority

6. ****define = make the shape/outline of something clear — 勾勒；使輪廓清晰****

A major visual/physical sense.

Practice 11

> “The dark line ****defines**** the edge of the shape.”

「深色線條**勾勒出**圖形的邊緣。」

Practice 12

> “The lighting defined the contours of her face.”

「燈光把她臉部的輪廓**勾勒得很清楚**。」

****define = 使某物的邊界、輪廓或形狀變得清楚可見****

This is genuinely distinct from dictionary definition.

7. ****defined = clearly shaped / outlined — 輪廓分明的；清晰的****

Practice 13

> “The mountain had a clearly ****defined**** outline.”

「那座山的輪廓非常**分明**。」

Practice 14

> “He has well-defined facial features.”

「他的五官輪廓很**鮮明**。」

****defined = 邊界、形狀或特徵清楚可辨的****

8. ****well-defined = 明確界定的；清晰的****

A very common compound.

Practice 15

> “The task has a ****well-defined**** goal.”

「這項任務有一個****明確界定的目標****。」

Practice 16

> “The concept is not well-defined.”

「這個概念並沒有被****清楚界定****。」

****well-defined = 意思、範圍、條件或邊界非常清楚的****

9. ****ill-defined = 界定不清的；模糊的****

Practice 17

> “The role is still ****ill-defined****.”

「這個角色的職責仍然****界定不清****。」

Practice 18

> “The symptoms were vague and ill-defined.”

「症狀很模糊，而且****不明確****。」

****ill-defined = 缺乏清楚界線、意思或特徵的****

10. ****definition = exact meaning — 定義****

The main noun meaning.

Practice 19

> “What is the ****definition**** of ‘success’?”

「success 的****定義****是甚麼？」

Practice 20

> “The two dictionaries give slightly different definitions.”

「兩本字典給出的****定義****略有不同。」

****definition = 對字詞 / 概念確切意思的說明****

11. ****definition = act/process of setting limits — 界定；界說****

A broader formal sense.

Practice 21

> “The legal ****definition**** of the term is very narrow.”

「這個詞在法律上的****界定****很狹窄。」

Practice 22

> “Clear definition of responsibilities prevents confusion.”

「清楚****界定責任****可以避免混亂。」

****definition = 對範圍、角色、標準或概念作正式界定****

12. ****definition = clarity/sharpness of an image/sound — 清晰度；解析度感****

A major technical/media sense.

Practice 23

> “The image has excellent **definition**.”

「這張影像的**清晰度**很好。」

Practice 24

> “The camera captures fine detail with high definition.”

「這部相機能以**高清晰度**捕捉細節。」

definition — visual/audio = 細節、輪廓或影像呈現得有多清楚

This leads to:

> **high-definition / HD** = 高清的

13. **high-definition** = 高清的

Practice 25

> “The video was recorded in **high-definition**.”

「這段影片以**高清**格式錄製。」

Practice 26

> “The television has a high-definition display.”

「這部電視配備**高清顯示屏**。」

high-definition = 具有高影像解析 / 清晰度的

14. **definite** = certain / clear — 肯定的；明確的

A related adjective, but semantically distinct from **define**.

Practice 27

> “We need a **definite** answer.”

「我們需要一個**明確的答案**。」

Practice 28

> “There has been a definite improvement.”

「情況有了**明顯 / 確實的改善**。」

definite = 清楚、確定、不模糊的

Important:

definite does not simply mean “defined”.

15. **definite** = fixed/decided — 確定的；已決定的

Practice 29

> “No **definite** date has been set.”

「目前還沒有**確定的日期**。」

Practice 30

> “They have no definite plan yet.”

「他們目前還沒有**確定的計劃**。」

definite = 已確定、不再模糊或未定的

16. **definitive** = authoritative/final — 權威性的；最終的；定論性的

A very useful related adjective.

Practice 31

> “There is no **definitive** answer yet.”

「目前還沒有**最終定論**。」

Practice 32

> “This is regarded as the definitive study of the subject.”

「這被視為該課題最**權威的研究**。」

definitive = 足以作為最終結論、標準或權威版本的

17. **definitive = most complete/representative version — 最完整權威的；經典定本**

Practice 33

> “The book is the **definitive** guide to the topic.”

「這本書是該主題最**權威完整的指南**。」

Practice 34

> “They released a definitive edition of the album.”

「他們推出了這張專輯的**權威定本 / 最完整版本**。」

definitive = 被視為最完整、最可靠、可作標準的版本

Important distinction: **define vs describe**

describe

= tell what something is like.

define

= state exactly what it means / what its boundaries are.

> describe a bakery

> = 描述麵包店有甚麼特點

> define a bakery

> = 界定甚麼才算 bakery

So **define** is more exact and boundary-focused.

Important distinction: **define vs explain**

explain

= make something understandable, often how/why.

define

= state exact meaning.

> define “viral”

> = 說明 viral 的確切意思

> explain why the video went viral

> = 解釋影片為甚麼爆紅

Important distinction: **define vs identify**

You already curated **identify**.

identify

= determine which person/thing something is.

define

= state what it means or what characteristics/boundaries make it what it is.

> identify the problem

> = 找出問題是哪一個

> define the problem

> = 清楚界定問題本身是甚麼

Excellent academic contrast.

Important distinction: **define vs determine**

determine

= decide/cause the outcome or establish a fact.

****define****

= set the meaning, character, or limits.

> price determines demand

> = 價格決定需求

> values define the brand

> = 價值觀界定 / 塑造品牌特色

In the source sentence, ****define me**** approaches “determine who I am”.

Important distinction: ****define vs label****

****label****

= attach a category/name, often simplistically.

****define****

= determine the essential character or limits.

> label someone as lazy

> = 把某人標籤為懶惰

> let one failure define someone

> = 讓一次失敗決定對這個人的整體看法

****Define**** is broader and deeper.

Important distinction: ****define vs judge****

You already have ****judge**** mapped.

****judge****

= form an evaluation.

****define****

= let that evaluation determine someone's identity/essential character.

> “They judged me negatively.”

> = 他們對我作負面評價。

> “Their judgement does not define me.”

> = 他們的評價不能決定我是怎樣的人。

Very relevant to your passage.

Important distinction: **defined vs definite**

These look similar but are not interchangeable.

defined

= given clear boundaries/meaning/shape.

> clearly defined role

> = 清楚界定的角色

definite

= certain/clear/decided.

> definite answer

> = 明確肯定的答案

So:

> well-defined plan

> = 計劃內容 / 範圍清楚

> definite plan

> = 已經有確定計劃

Subtle but important.

Important distinction: **definite vs definitive**

definite

= certain / clear.

****definitive****

= final / authoritative / conclusive.

> definite answer

> = 明確答案

> definitive answer

> = 最終且具決定性的答案

****Definitive**** is stronger.

Important distinction: ****definition — meaning vs image quality****

Language:

> “dictionary definition”

= 字典定義

Technology:

> “high definition”

= 高清

Completely different domains.

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: ****define — conceptual vs visual****

Conceptual:

> “Define the term.”

= 定義這個術語。

Visual:

> “The light defines the edge.”

= 光線把邊緣勾勒出來。

Underlying semantic bridge:

> ****make boundaries clear****

That is the central concept connecting these senses.

Important distinction: ****define me in your passage****

Your sentence:

> “strangers on the internet do not know me well enough to define me.”

does ****not**** mean:

> 「陌生人不懂得查字典定義我。」

It means:

> ****陌生人的批評不能決定作者的整體身份、人格或價值。****

It is a figurative identity sense.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* ****define — word/concept**** = 定義 / 解釋確切意思

* ****define A as B**** = 把 A 定義為 B

* ****define — essential character**** = 界定 / 塑造核心特質

* ****define — person/identity**** = 替某人下定論 / 決定其身份特質

* ****define — scope/boundary**** = 界定範圍 / 責任

* ****define — visual outline**** = 勾勒 / 使輪廓清晰

* ****defined**** = 界線 / 輪廓清晰的

* ****well-defined**** = 明確界定的

* ****ill-defined**** = 界定不清的

* ****definition — meaning**** = 定義

* ****definition — boundary**** = 界定

* ****definition — image quality**** = 清晰度

* ****high-definition**** = 高清的

****define**** = 明確 / 確定的
****definitive**** = 最終 / 權威 / 定論性的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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define — word/concept	清楚說明某個字、概念或術語的確切意思
define A as B	明確規定 / 說明 A 所指的是 B
define — essential character	顯示或塑造某人 / 某物最具代表性的核心特徵
define — identity	把某個評價 / 事件當成決定一個人身份或價值的標準
define — scope	明確訂出某事物的範圍、界線、責任或限制
define — visual	使某物的邊界、輪廓或形狀清楚可見
well-defined	意思、範圍、條件或邊界清楚明確的
ill-defined	缺乏清楚界線、意思或特徵的
definition — language	對字詞 / 概念確切意思的說明
definition — visual/technical	影像 / 聲音細節和輪廓的清晰程度
definite	清楚、確定、沒有模糊或未決狀態的
definitive	足以作為最終結論、權威標準或完整版本的

For your original sentence

> “I knew, logically, that strangers on the internet do not know me well enough to ****define**** me.”

The exact meaning is:

****define** = 網上陌生人的幾句批評不能決定作者是一個怎樣的人，也不能界定其身份、人格或自我價值。******

Natural translation:

> ******「理性上，我知道網上的陌生人根本不夠了解我，不能憑幾句說話就替我下定論、界定我是怎樣的人。」******

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****define a word**** → 定義一個字
- > ****define A as B**** → 把 A 定義為 B
- > ****define a role**** → 界定角色 / 職責
- > ****define a person**** → 界定某人是怎樣的人
- > ****define the edge**** → 勾勒邊緣
- > ****well-defined goal**** → 明確界定的目標
- > ****definition of a word**** → 字詞定義
- > ****high definition**** → 高清

> ****definite answer**** → 明確 / 肯定的答案

> ****definitive answer**** → 最終 / 具決定性的答案